

symbol instance without affecting the others, right-click the instance and select Ungroup Symbol. Remember that doing this creates a new symbol.

Now, let's say you have created a Login button - a rectangular box with blue text on it. You want to use the same button for other options like Subscribe, Share etc. But the text is different so will you need to create another button from scratch? Nope, no need for that. Drag the Login button symbol on the artboard and select the text part of it. Change the text to Subscribe and other instances of this symbol remain unaffected. Don't change any property like font size, that will affect all symbols. If you wish to update this across all instances, right click and select update all symbols. Same for bitmap images used on a symbol - even they can be overwritten.

You can find an asset used on your canvas by right clicking on the asset in the panel and then selecting 'Highlight on Canvas' option. To do a reverse search, right click the object and select the 'Reveal (colour/ character style/ object) in Assets' option.

Later in DIY Part 2, you will see how to import external assets from photoshop, illustrator, sketch and web browsers or saved image files into your XD file. To export an asset as an image, select the object and under the Hamburger menu click on Export. Use the selected object option. If you want to export an entire artboard as an image, select the artboard and choose the Export artboard option. If you select an artboard and choose the Selected object option, all the objects on the artboard will be exported as separate image files.

Layers

Layers in Adobe XD have been reinvented from the tool used in Illustrator and Photoshop making them more friendly to the focus group of UI/ UX designers. Appearing on the left side of the screen, this panel can be accessed by pressing Ctrl + Y on either Windows or Mac or the icon situated just below the Assets Panel icon.

Layers displays all the artboards and objects on the pasteboard in your file. Double click on an artboard to display all objects on that artboard. This layering (no pun intended) helps to keep your layer panel uncluttered and easy to navigate. Double clicking also zooms in to that artboard. To exit that artboard either click on the back button next to the title on the Layer panel or click anywhere on the pasteboard.

Every object is also a layer by itself. Every text box, shape, symbol etc. is a layer. If you have grouped objects together, the group becomes a layer